

You cannot strictly "disable" the hardware or software back and forward buttons in a user's browser, as these are security and user-interface features controlled by the browser itself. However, you can use JavaScript to **intercept and block** navigation by manipulating the browser's history or prompting the user before they leave. [GeeksforGeeks +4](#)

1. The History API Method (Recommended)

This method effectively "traps" the user on the current page by constantly adding the current URL back into the history stack whenever the user tries to navigate away. [OutSystems +2](#)

javascript

```
// Push the current state to history
history.pushState(null, null, document.URL);

// Listen for the "back" or "forward" event
window.addEventListener('popstate', function () {
    // Immediately push the current state back to keep the user here
    history.pushState(null, null, document.URL);
});
```

Use code with caution.

- **How it works:** When the user clicks "Back," the `popstate` event fires. This script immediately pushes the current URL back into the stack, overriding the navigation attempt. [Bubble Forum +3](#)

2. The `onbeforeunload` Prompt

If you want to prevent the user from accidentally leaving a page (e.g., during a payment or form submission), you can trigger a browser confirmation dialog. [GeeksforGeeks +1](#)

javascript

```
window.onbeforeunload = function() {
    return "Are you sure you want to leave? Your changes may not be saved.";
};
```

Use code with caution.

- **Note:** Modern browsers (Chrome, Firefox) often ignore custom text and show a generic "Are you sure you want to leave this site?" message to prevent site owners from confusing users.  GeeksforGeeks +2

3. Immediate Forward Loop

This older technique forces the browser to go forward as soon as it detects it has gone back.  ASPSnippets +1

javascript

```
function preventBack() {  
    window.history.forward();  
}  
  
setTimeout("preventBack()", 0);  
  
window.onunload = function() {  
    null;  
};
```

Use code with caution.

- **Application:** This is commonly used on **Logout** or **Login** pages to prevent a user from clicking "Back" and seeing sensitive data from a previous session.  ASPSnippets +3

Important Considerations

- **User Experience (UX):** Breaking the back button is generally considered a "dark pattern" and can frustrate users. Only use it for critical flows like secure exams or payment gateways.
- **Security:** These methods are **client-side only**. They do not provide real security. To properly protect a page, use server-side session management (e.g., clearing sessions or using `Cache-Control: no-store` headers).

- **Mobile Support:** On mobile devices, these scripts can sometimes be bypassed by "swipe-to-back" gestures or closing the tab entirely.  Stack Overflow +4